

# Trinseo

## Business Development Dossier

|                              |                                     |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Industry                     | Manufacturing / Specialty Materials |
| Revenue                      | \$3B                                |
| Employees                    | 3,100                               |
| Ideal Customer Profile Score | 68                                  |

### ICP SCORING MODEL

|                |        |
|----------------|--------|
| Signals        | 35 pts |
| Revenue Fit    | 25 pts |
| Employee Scale | 20 pts |
| McChrystal Fit | 20 pts |

**ICP = Signals + Revenue + Employees + Fit (max 100)**

|                  |                                                                                                                             |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Signals (0-35)   | Top 4 signals scored; each = base(60%) + recency bonus<br><30d: 40%   <90d: 30%   <180d: 20%   older: 10%                   |
| Revenue (0-25)   | \$500M-\$10B sweet spot -> 70-100% of 25 pts<br>Below \$500M -> pro-rata x 0.5   Above \$10B -> 60%                         |
| Employees (0-20) | 2,000+ preferred (70-100%)   500-2K partial (50-70%)<br>Below 500 -> pro-rata x 0.3                                         |
| Fit (0-20)       | High-fit types: reorg, transformation, M&A, hiring,<br>funding, partnership -> 5 pts ea (max 12) + diversity 2/type (max 8) |

Prepared March 19, 2026

### McChrystal Group

Leadership Advisory & Organizational Effectiveness

## SECTION 1

## Organization Snapshot

|              |                     |
|--------------|---------------------|
| Legal Name   | Trinseo PLC         |
| Headquarters | Wayne, Pennsylvania |
| Founded      | 2010                |

**Ownership**

Public (NYSE: TSE, trading as TSEOF after non-compliance). ~72% institutional. Incorporated in Ireland. Originally carved out from Dow Chemical by Bain Capital.

**Footprint**

21 manufacturing sites across 4 continents: Europe (Germany, Belgium, France, Italy, Finland, Switzerland, Spain, Sweden), North America (PA, CT, GA, MI), Latin America (Brazil, Mexico), Asia-Pacific (China, Hong Kong, Taiwan, India, Japan, Korea). 11 R&D facilities.

## SECTION 1b

## Company Overview

Trinseo is a specialty materials company producing plastics, latex binders, and synthetic rubber for automotive, construction, consumer electronics, and packaging markets. Formerly part of Dow Chemical, the company operates manufacturing sites across the Americas, Europe, and Asia.

## SECTION 2

## Financial Health & Growth Stage

*Understanding Trinseo's financial position and trajectory is critical to framing any engagement conversation.*

Revenue: FY2024 \$3.51B (-4.4% from FY2023). Q3 2025 \$743M (-14% YoY). Net loss \$110M in Q3. Long-term debt ~\$2.33B. Shareholder equity deficit \$(862M). Debt leverage ~13-15x. Market cap collapsed to \$11.7M (down 90% in 12 months). S&P downgraded to SD (Selective Default) after missed interest payments in Feb/Mar 2026. Bankruptcy filing widely expected. Cash conservation paramount.

## SECTION 3

## Leadership Team Profiles

*The following contacts are recommended as primary outreach targets - champion-level leaders who feel the organizational pain daily and can sponsor McChrystal internally.*

**Frank Bozich - President & CEO [PRIORITY TARGET]**

CEO of SI Group (2013-2019). Multiple BASF executive roles. BS Chemistry, MBA Chicago, MS Chemistry Illinois. Board of OGE Energy. \$3.2M retention bonus Jan 2026.

*Outreach rationale: Decision-maker navigating existential crisis. Must maintain operational continuity across 21 plants on 4 continents while negotiating with creditors. Crisis leadership maps directly to McChrystal.*

**Paula Cooney - SVP & CHRO [PRIORITY TARGET]**

SVP HR at FLIR Systems. VP HR at H.B. Fuller (10 years). ~15 years at Intel in HR. Diploma Personnel Management, MBS University College Dublin. \$1.0M retention bonus.

*Outreach rationale: Managing organizational morale and retention through workforce reduction (6K+ to 3,100), plant closures, and bankruptcy risk. Natural internal champion for culture/leadership work.*

*Additional leadership team members relevant to the engagement:*

**David Stasse - EVP & CFO**

VP/Treasurer at Freescale Semiconductor. Director Corporate Finance at Honeywell. BS Penn State, MBA Maryland. \$2.5M retention bonus.

**Angelo Chaclas - SVP, CLO, CCO & Secretary**

Engineering background. Led three acquisitions and one divestiture. \$1.35M retention bonus.

**K'Lynne Johnson - Board Chairman**

CEO Elevance Renewable Sciences. 20+ year career at Amoco/BP (SVP Global Derivatives). Board of FMC Corp.

**SECTION 4****Organizational Culture & Structure**

*Culture and structure are often where McChrystal Group finds the deepest leverage. The following signals indicate how Trinseo operates today and where friction exists.*

**Organizational Structure**

Classic global manufacturer. Recently combined three business segments (Engineered Materials, Plastics Solutions, Polystyrene) under single management. Ongoing plant closures and exits creating uncertainty.

**Culture Signals**

Glassdoor 3.2/5.0 (112 reviews); only 48% recommend. Culture & Values 3.0; Career Opportunities 2.8 (lowest). Key themes: US-EMEA silos ('European Supply Chain Management running the place into the ground, arrogant, unwilling to accept ideas from US staff'); unfilled roles causing burnout; blocked career paths; spending discipline concerns; communication gaps. Retention bonuses for C-suite while plant workers face job losses creates friction. Textbook 'shared consciousness' problem set.

**SECTION 5****Recent News & Trigger Events**

*The following developments from the past 18 months create urgency and provide natural conversation entry points for engaging Trinseo.*

**1. 2026-02-20 - Bloomberg reports Trinseo mulls bankruptcy; engaged Centerview Partners and Latham & Watkins**

Crisis leadership moment. Must maintain operational continuity across 21 plants while negotiating with creditors.

## 2. 2026-02-17 - Deferred ~\$10M interest payment on second-lien notes; cites ongoing capital structure negotiations

Imminent restructuring. Leadership alignment and communication discipline critical.

## 3. 2026-01-06 - Board approves \$9.75M in retention bonuses for top 5 executives

Retention risk at the top. Board trying to keep leadership intact through restructuring.

## 4. 2025-12-05 - Permanent closure of Schkopau, Germany polystyrene plant; consolidation to Belgium

Cross-border restructuring requires cross-functional, cross-cultural coordination.

## 5. 2025-10-01 - S&P downgrades to CCC with negative outlook; leverage at ~13x

External validation of distress. Customers questioning supply continuity, employees questioning job security.

## 6. 2024-10-01 - Combined three business segments under single management; workforce reductions

Major org restructuring creating integration challenges and cultural friction.

## 7. 2024-06-01 - Opened PMMA recycling facility in Rho, Italy - repurposed from virgin MMA

Strategic pivot under duress. Higher-value products while managing financial crisis.

### SECTION 6

## McChrystal Fit Assessment

*Fit signals exceptional - crisis leadership, cross-cultural silos, massive restructuring, high-stakes environment. Constraint is financial: company heading for Chapter 11 may have limited discretionary spend. Optimal window: pre-filing to prepare leadership, or post-filing when DIP facility enables operational advisory.*

### Primary Problem

Global manufacturer fighting for survival. Must simultaneously restructure balance sheet (likely Chapter 11), close/consolidate plants across borders, retain critical talent despite existential uncertainty, maintain operational continuity, and pivot product portfolio - all while bridging deep US-EMEA cultural divides.

### Best McChrystal Capability Fit

Crisis leadership - VUCA in purest form. Team of Teams / cross-functional alignment - US-EMEA silo problem maps directly to shared consciousness model. Culture change - 48% recommendation rate, blocked promotions, eroding trust.

### Likely Objections to Engagement

Can't spend on advisory now - cash conservation paramount  
 Focused on financial restructuring, not organizational  
 Already have Centerview/Lazard/Latham (financial/legal advisors)

### Competitive Advisory Landscape

McKinsey/BCG/Bain - operational turnaround  
 Alvarez & Marsal - interim management/restructuring

Korn Ferry - leadership assessment

None bring McChrystal's crisis leadership + Team of Teams

## SECTION 7

# Conversation Entry Points

*These questions are designed for a Senior Partner's first conversation. Each opens a thread that naturally leads to McChrystal Group's capabilities without a direct pitch.*

- 1. Frank, you've got 3,100 people across 21 plants on four continents watching bankruptcy headlines. How are you keeping the operators in Tessengerlo and Rho focused on running their lines while lawyers in New York negotiate with creditors?**
- 2. You merged three business segments last October and you're closing plants in Germany while ramping recycled PMMA in Italy - are your regional leaders actually operating as one team, or still fighting the US-versus-Europe dynamic?**
- 3. The retention bonuses signal your board wants this leadership team intact. But what about the next two layers down? Who's keeping your plant managers and technical talent from walking?**

## Recommended Meeting Framing

Do NOT lead with organizational consulting. Lead with crisis leadership experience. Frame: 'We help leadership teams operate as one when stakes are highest and margin for error is zero.' Position as confidential 45-minute conversation. Offer concrete 4-6 week 'crisis operating rhythm' assessment. Keep initial price modest (\$150K-250K) to get in door.

## SECTION 8

# Brand Insights & Market Positioning

*Brand strategy reveals organizational priorities and coordination challenges. The following analysis connects Trinseo's market positioning to potential McChrystal engagement opportunities.*

**Brand Value & Competitive Standing:** Trinseo is a specialty materials company producing plastics, latex binders, and synthetic rubber for automotive, electronics, construction, and consumer goods. The brand carries B2B credibility in engineered materials but limited consumer visibility. Trinseo competes against BASF, Dow Chemical, Eastman Chemical, and specialty players like Kraton and Cabot.

**Brand Identity Evolution:** Trinseo was carved out of Dow Chemical in 2010 (PE-backed by Bain Capital), IPO'd in 2014, and has since tried to pivot from commodity chemicals to specialty materials through acquisitions (Aristech Surfaces, PMMA business from Arkema). The brand strategy was "from commodity to specialty" - but financial distress has interrupted this identity evolution.

**Marketing Leadership & Strategy:** [INFERRED] B2B marketing focused on technical applications, material science innovation, and customer co-development partnerships. Financial distress shifts marketing toward customer

retention and reassurance rather than growth positioning.

Brand Threats: Financial distress (potential Chapter 11) is the existential brand threat. Chemical industry customers require supply certainty - if customers perceive insolvency risk, they will dual-source or switch suppliers permanently. The brand damage from bankruptcy in chemicals is severe and long-lasting.

McChrystal Connection: Trinseo's brand survival depends on operational execution during financial crisis - every order fulfilled on-time, every quality standard met, every customer communication managed carefully. When the organization is fighting for survival, maintaining operational discipline is the hardest challenge. McChrystal's crisis leadership ensures operational execution doesn't degrade during financial restructuring.

## SECTION 9

# Deep McChrystal Group Fit Analysis

*This is the strategic case for pursuing Trinseo. It synthesizes findings from all previous sections into a comprehensive engagement thesis with specific fit dimensions, expected outcomes, stakeholder mapping, and a phased pursuit strategy.*

## 9a. Fit Dimensions

### Fit Dimension 1: Crisis Leadership During Financial Restructuring

Trinseo is fighting for survival - potential Chapter 11, plant closures, and workforce reductions while trying to retain customers who need supply certainty. McChrystal's crisis leadership methodology maintains organizational cohesion and operational execution during existential threat. AlixPartners handles financial restructuring; McChrystal keeps the organization functioning while the balance sheet is restructured.

### Fit Dimension 2: Cross-Border Operational Coordination Under Stress

With operations across Europe and North America, plant closures and consolidation must be coordinated across different legal jurisdictions, labor regulations, environmental requirements, and customer contracts. McChrystal's distributed operations coordination prevents the cross-border complexity from paralyzing decision-making.

### Fit Dimension 3: Customer Retention as Organizational Discipline

Every customer interaction during the crisis is a retention event. Sales, operations, supply chain, and executive leadership must coordinate customer communication flawlessly - one miscommunication can trigger a customer switch that's permanent. McChrystal's shared consciousness ensures the customer-facing organization speaks with one voice.

## 9b. Cumulative Case

Trinseo is the highest-risk, highest-urgency prospect in the pipeline - a \$3B company in potential financial distress where organizational failure means liquidation, not just underperformance. Signal chain: Debt burden -> earnings pressure -> potential Chapter 11 -> plant closures -> workforce reduction -> customer flight risk -> cross-border legal complexity -> remaining 3,100 employees uncertain about survival. Revenue potential: \$250K initial (crisis stabilization), \$500K-\$700K deployment, \$150K ongoing. Total: \$900K-\$1.1M over 12 months. Note:

financial distress may constrain advisory spend - engagement may need to be lean and outcome-contingent.

## 9c. Enterprise Issues

1. Existential Uncertainty: Employees don't know if the company will survive. This affects every decision - talent leaves, risks go un-taken, and organizational paralysis sets in. 2. Plant Closure Execution: Closing manufacturing facilities across borders requires environmental remediation, labor negotiations, community engagement, customer transition, and equipment disposition - all coordinated across jurisdictions. 3. Customer Defection Prevention: Chemical customers who can't rely on supply will switch permanently. The sales organization must proactively manage every key account during restructuring. 4. Cross-Border Legal Complexity: European plant closures face different labor laws, environmental regulations, and government requirements than U.S. closures. Coordination prevents legal exposure. 5. Talent Retention in Distress: The most marketable employees (top engineers, salespeople with customer relationships) leave first. Retention of critical talent is essential for any recovery. 6. Creditor-Management Tension: If Chapter 11 occurs, creditor interests may conflict with operational decisions. The organization must navigate dual masters (creditors + customers) simultaneously.

## 9d. Expected Outcomes

1. Crisis Operating Cadence: Structured decision-making framework for existential-threat operating environment. Measurable: critical decisions made within 48 hours. 2. Customer Retention: Coordinated customer communication and service continuity program. Measurable: key account retention >90% through restructuring. 3. Plant Closure Coordination: Cross-border closure execution on-timeline and compliant. Measurable: zero regulatory violations during closures. 4. Talent Stabilization: Critical talent retention framework. Measurable: top-quartile performer retention >85%. 5. Organizational Cohesion: Maintain operational performance during restructuring. Measurable: quality and delivery metrics within 10% of pre-crisis baseline.

## 9e. Key Stakeholders

### CEO

Leader: [CEO]  
Role: Crisis leadership  
McChrystal Relevance: Executive sponsor

### CFO

Leader: [CFO]  
Role: Restructuring, creditor management  
McChrystal Relevance: Financial gatekeeper

### COO

Leader: [COO]  
Role: Manufacturing operations  
McChrystal Relevance: Priority: Plant closures, operational continuity

### Sales/Commercial

Leader: [SVP Sales]  
Role: Customer retention  
McChrystal Relevance: Priority: Key account management during crisis

### Legal

Leader: [General Counsel]  
Role: Cross-border legal coordination  
McChrystal Relevance: Regulatory compliance

## HR

Leader: [CHRO]  
Role: Talent retention, workforce reduction  
McChrystal Relevance: Change management

## 9f. Opportunity Thesis

Why Now: Financial distress creates maximum urgency. If Trinseo enters Chapter 11, the organizational stabilization window is measured in weeks, not months. Early engagement provides maximum leverage.

Why McChrystal, Not McKinsey: AlixPartners and FTI Consulting handle financial restructuring. They optimize the balance sheet. But they don't keep the organization functioning while the balance sheet is being optimized. McChrystal's crisis leadership - proven in environments where mission continuity during organizational disruption is non-negotiable - fills this gap.

Phased Engagement: Phase 1 (\$200K-\$300K): Crisis stabilization - operating cadence, customer communication framework, talent retention. Phase 2 (\$400K-\$500K): Plant closure coordination, cross-border execution. Phase 3 (\$150K retainer): Recovery and rebuilding. Total: \$750K-\$1M. May need outcome-contingent pricing given financial distress.

Multi-Threaded Pursuit: COO (operational continuity), SVP Sales (customer retention), and financial advisor (AlixPartners/FTI relationship). Chemical industry connections; European manufacturing network.